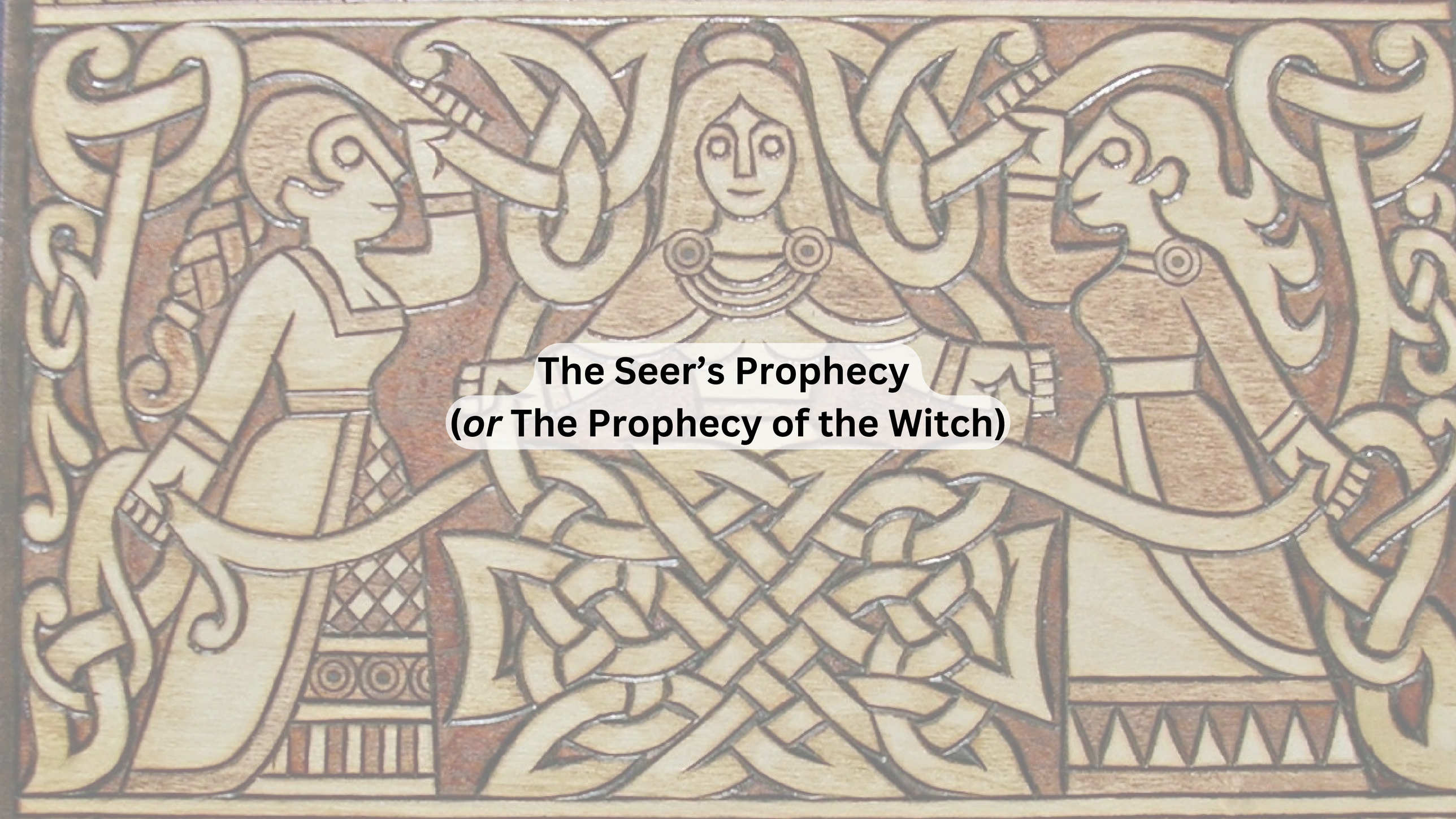

The Seer’s Prophecy
(*or* The Prophecy of the Witch)

Why this piece is important

The Seer’s Prophecy explores the question of whether we are doomed to repeat cycles of violence, destruction, and societal patterns, or if we can evolve and grow through these recurring revolutions of the wheel. The show delves into these themes through the lens of female seers and witches—characters whose wisdom and voices are often marginalized or forgotten. By focusing on these often-overlooked figures, the work challenges the traditional narratives and power structures, asking whether we can break free from destructive cycles and create a new path forward, both as individuals and as a society. The show’s exploration of fate, power, and transformation speaks to the universal struggle for change and growth in the face of repeating histories.

Short Synopsis

At the edge of time, beneath the roots of Yggdrasil, Odin summons a long-dead Seer to unveil the fate of the gods. But the Seer is not one voice alone—she is many, woven from the wisdom of those who came before: the Norns, who spin the threads of destiny; Gullveig, a sorceress burned and reborn; and Frigg, whose foresight cannot prevent her son’s doom. Through their eyes, the story unfolds—of the world's birth in fire and ice, of gods who rise and fall, and of the fate that even the Allfather cannot escape.

As past and present entwine in haunting folk melodies, shadow play, and prophecy, The Seer’s Prophecy is a mythic journey of creation and destruction, power and persecution, and the question that lingers beyond the end of all things: can the cycle ever be broken?

Synopsis: The Seer's Prophecy (Working Title)
A Folk Opera Inspired by Völuspá

Framing Device: Odin and the Seer (The Norns)

The three Norns—Urðr (Past), Verðandi (Present), and Skuld (Future) weave the threads of fate at the world tree of Yggdrasil's roots, their voices entwined in song.

Odin makes his way to the Norns, but does not see them.
He calls a wise Seer from the beyond to give him wisdom on Ragnorok, the end of days to come.

The Seer materializes, played collectively by the three Norns.

Through their words, the past, present, and future unfold, proving their knowledge and revealing what is to come.

***The Norns, the Seer, and Odin (when he is in conversation with the Seer) all live outside of the flow of time that the rest of the action of the show takes place within.

ACT ONE: THE PAST (Creation, Power, and the Rise of the Aesir)

1. Song of the Norns

The three Norns chant in layered polyphony, invoking the web of fate. Odin approaches, demanding wisdom. The Seer acknowledges him and begins her prophecy.

2. It All Started with Fire and Ice (Puppetry & Shadow Play: The Creation Myth)

The Seer recounts the beginning: the void of Ginnungagap, the clash of fire from Muspelheim and ice from Niflheim, and the birth of Ymir, the primordial giant. Odin and his brothers slay Ymir, shaping the world from his body. They breathe life into Ask and Embla, the first humans.

3. The Golden Age & The Corruption of Power

The gods establish Asgard, and for a time, harmony reigns. But power breeds greed. The Seer introduces Gullveig, a powerful seeress and wielder of magic (also played by the Norns). She teaches the gods seiðr, a form of magic, but Odin covets her knowledge. The Aesir call her a witch, stab her with spears, and burn her three times—each time, she is reborn. First as Heiðr, than as Freyja. Her suffering marks the first cracks in the gods' rule.

4. The War of the Gods (Instrumental & Spoken Word with Puppetry)

Gullveig’s treatment ignites war between the Aesir (warrior gods of Asgard) and the Vanir (fertility gods).
The war is futile; neither side wins. The gods broker a truce, exchanging hostages—Freyja joins Asgard, bringing seiðr with her. She watches Odin embrace the magic he once condemned, her presence a silent challenge.

5. The Binding of Fate (Norn Chorus)

The Norns weave the consequences of the gods’ choices into the fabric of fate. Odin, satisfied with the Seer’s knowledge of the past, presses her to speak of the present.

ACT TWO: THE PRESENT (The Death of Light, The Path to Ragnarök)

6. Oh Bright One and (Baldr's Praise & Loki's Skepticism)

The gods celebrate Baldr, Odin's golden son—beloved, pure, and seemingly untouchable.
The ensemble sings his praises, pleading for his wisdom.
Loki, ever the outsider, scoffs, asking what wisdom one can have who knows no suffering.
Baldr, troubled by dreams of his own death, is caught between his senses of love and duty and the darkness he feels coming.

7. Frigg's Bargain (A Mother's Love & The Illusion of Control)

Frigg, Baldr's mother, makes every being in existence swear not to harm him—except mistletoe, deemed too insignificant.
The gods, believing him invincible, make a game of throwing weapons at him, which bounce harmlessly away. Loki watches, seething at their arrogance.

8. The Trickster's Hand (The Fall of Baldr)

Loki crafts a mistletoe dart and gives it to Höðr, Baldr's blind brother. When Höðr throws it, Baldr falls dead. The gods are shattered.
Frigg begs Hel for mercy, who says that Baldr can go free if every soul weeps for him. Loki will not weep, sealing Baldr's fate in the underworld.

9. Descent into Chaos (The Breaking Point, Puppetry & Shadow Play)

Odin, enraged, binds Loki. The gods turn on one another, paranoia growing. The Seer asks Odin if he sees now, that the end has already begun.

ACT THREE: THE FUTURE (Ragnarök and the Cycle of Rebirth)

10. Loki’s Revenge & The Final Battle (Prophecy of the End)
The Seer describes the storm to come: Loki will break free, leading the forces of chaos. Fenrir will devour Odin. The world will burn. The gods will fall.

11. The Death & Rebirth of the World (The Phoenix from the Ashes)
The flames consume everything. The ocean swallows the earth. Silence. Then—new land rises from the sea. From the ashes, Baldr returns. The few survivors gather, looking toward an uncertain future.

12. It All Started with Fire and Ice (Reprise) (Finale: The Eternal Question)
The cycle begins again. The Norns weave, Baldr stands at the dawn of a new world, and the question lingers: will this time be different?

Character Breakdowns

The Three Norns

The Norns—Urðr (Fated), Verðandi (Becoming), and Skuld (Must-Be)—are the weavers of destiny, shaping the past, present, and future at the roots of Yggdrasil. They are not passive observers but active forces, each embodying a distinct aspect of time, fate, and feminine power. In The Seer's Prophecy, they serve as narrators, puppeteers, and manifestations of the Seer herself, weaving the story as they weave the threads of existence. They also embody other wise women of Norse mythology—Gullveig-Heiðr-Freyja and Frigg—drawing connections between those demonized or feared for their knowledge and magic.

Each Norn is a guardian of time, yet they are bound by it, unable to alter the fates they foretell. Their voices and movement reflect their nature: Urðr is slow and solemn, Verðandi is fluid and restless, and Skuld is sharp and inevitable.

The Three as One – The Seer, the Witches, the Condemned

The Norns are not just fate-weavers; they are the echoes of every woman in this story who has seen too much, known too much, and been punished for it. They become the Seer who speaks to Odin, the witches cast out and burned, the wise ones whose voices are feared, the background characters filling out the story.

They are bound to their roles yet inseparable, moving between past, present, and future in a dance of inevitability. Their harmony is ancient, their discord is the unraveling of time itself. And as they pull the threads together, one question remains—will this cycle ever change? Or must it all begin again



Urðr (Fated) – The Keeper of the Past

Represents: Memory, history, cause and effect, ancestral knowledge.
Personality: Wise, steady, and sorrowful. She carries the weight of all that has been, speaking with the solemnity of one who knows the consequences of every action. She often mourns rather than judges, her voice a whisper from the ages.

Role in the Story:
She recounts the world's birth from fire and ice, the rise of the Aesir, and the first injustices that set fate in motion.
She embodies Frigg, the mother who foresees Baldr’s death yet is powerless to stop it, representing the limits of even the most profound wisdom.

As part of the Seer, her voice grounds the prophecy in the weight of history.

The Three Norns



Verðandi (Becoming) – The Weaver of the Present

Represents: Change, motion, decision-making, the unfolding of fate.

Personality: Vibrant, passionate, and engaged with the moment. She is caught between what was and what will be, trying to hold the threads together even as they fray. She is neither resigned like Urðr nor as harsh as Skuld—she is the one who feels fate as it happens.

Role in the Story:

She narrates the gods' present struggles—the politics, betrayals, and self-deceptions that drive them toward their doom.

She embodies Heiðr, the wandering seeress who practices magic and prophecy, feared and revered in equal measure. Through Heiðr, she explores the persecution of those with knowledge that challenges power.

As part of the Seer, she is the most immediate and engaging, the thread that connects Odin's questions to the weight of fate.

The Three Norns

Skuld (Must-Be) – The Herald of the Future



Represents: The inescapable, the unknown, death and rebirth, the destruction that allows creation.
Personality: Cold, resolute, and unyielding. She does not mourn like Urðr or resist like Verðandi—she is what must come. There is steel in her voice, the certainty of a blade falling. She is not cruel, but she has no pity.

Role in the Story:
She reveals Ragnarök and its inevitability, showing Odin not only his death but the death of the world he helped create.
She embodies Gullveig, burned and reborn, a figure of both destruction and renewal. She is the proof that what is killed does not stay dead, that the cycle will continue, but not without pain.
As part of the Seer, she is the final voice, the last thread woven, the answer to Odin’s question: nothing can stop what has been set in motion.

Odin

Odin, the Allfather, is a god of paradoxes—both seeker and tyrant, wisdom-gatherer and war-bringer, the ruler of the Aesir yet forever restless in his pursuit of knowledge. He is a figure of towering intellect and deep insecurity, willing to sacrifice anything—his eye, his honor, even his own son—to stave off the doom he knows is coming. In The Seer's Prophecy, Odin arrives at the roots of Yggdrasil, demanding answers from the Seer, yet his questioning is laced with fear. He covets the wisdom of the Norns, the magic of Gullveig-Heiðr-Freyja, and the foresight of Frigg, yet he wields power in a world that condemns those same gifts in others. His presence is both commanding and haunted, the weight of fate pressing down upon him as he searches desperately for a way to escape it—only to find that even the king of the gods is bound by the threads of destiny.

Loki

Loki is a figure of contradictions—clever, charismatic, and unpredictable, yet deeply alienated from the gods he moves among. Neither fully Aesir nor Jötunn, he belongs everywhere and nowhere, slipping between roles as trickster, instigator, and, ultimately, destroyer. In The Seer's Prophecy, Loki challenges the illusion of order, exposing the gods' fears, egos, and the lies they tell themselves to keep the world from unraveling. He sees fate more clearly than most, but whether he fights against it or pushes it forward is never entirely clear. He ridicules Baldr's innocence, mocks Odin's hunger for knowledge, and understands, more than anyone, that the end is inevitable. Yet for all his chaos, there is something almost tragic about him—an outsider in a world that was never built to hold him, caught in the very story he helps set into motion.

Baldr

Baldr is the son of Odin and Frigg, known for his beauty, kindness, and wisdom. He is loved by all the gods and seen as a symbol of light and hope. But despite his privileged place in Asgard, Baldr is troubled—he dreams of his own death, visions that he doesn't fully understand but can't shake. In The Seer's Prophecy, he struggles with the weight of expectation, caught between his own innocence and the harsh realities of the world around him. He wants to believe in fairness and goodness, but as events unfold, he starts to see the cracks in the gods' world. Loki mocks him for his sheltered perspective, while Odin and Frigg try desperately to shield him from the fate he fears. Baldr's death is inevitable, but it's not the end—his rebirth is the hope for a new cycle, a new beginning in the wake of destruction. Yet, even in his return, there is a question of what will truly change and if anything can escape the pull of fate.

Puppetry

In The Seer’s Prophecy, simple shadow puppetry will be used to heighten the storytelling and create a dramatic, immersive atmosphere. By playing with scale and perspective, the puppetry will allow us to amplify key moments in the narrative—such as the creation myth or the rise of the Aesir—without the need for elaborate sets or props. The puppets themselves will be minimal, relying on silhouettes and shadows projected onto the backdrop to evoke depth and movement. This technique will not only add visual intrigue but also emphasize the mythic, otherworldly nature of the story, while keeping the overall aesthetic simple and cost-effective. The goal is to use shadow and light to enhance the emotional and thematic elements of the performance, drawing the audience into a world where the lines between the gods, fate, and the unknown blur.

Costumes

The costumes in The Seer's Prophecy will be designed with simplicity and versatility in mind, using layers of cloth that can be creatively added or removed to help the small cast play multiple characters. Each actor will have a base costume, with strips or sections of fabric that can be tied, draped, or rearranged throughout the performance. This will allow for quick transformations, symbolizing the fluidity of identity and the interconnectedness of the characters. The layering and manipulation of cloth will also reflect the themes of weaving and fate, with the threads of the costumes acting as a visual representation of the threads of destiny that bind the gods, the Norns, and the Seer. The minimalistic approach will maintain focus on the story while offering room for symbolic gestures and transitions, making the costumes an integral part of the show's visual language.



Tech

The lighting in The Seer's Prophecy will be simple yet dramatic, designed to highlight the characters and puppetry while creating a rich atmosphere. With minimal set and props, the lighting will play a key role in focusing attention on the action and shaping the emotional tone of each scene. The use of shadows and highlights will evoke imagery of branches and weaving, reinforcing the themes of fate and interconnectedness. The sound will be equally minimal, atmospheric in nature, supporting the music without overwhelming it. Subtle soundscapes will enhance the mood, creating texture and depth while allowing the performances and music to remain at the forefront. Together, the lighting and sound will work seamlessly to immerse the audience in a world where the visual and auditory elements intertwine to heighten the mythic experience.

The Music

The musical performance in The Seer's Prophecy will be driven by either a small band or the actors themselves, depending on the needs of the moment. If a band is included, it will consist of 2-3 musicians, likely with 1-2 string players, alongside a person overseeing the looping process, adding ambient sounds, droning, and percussive elements to guide the atmosphere. If no band is used, the actors will take on the role of playing instruments as needed, with heavier atmospheric elements pre-recorded to fill in the sound. Wireless mics will be used for all 6 actors to ensure clear vocals while allowing for movement, and looping will be employed to build group numbers, create a layered atmosphere, and deepen the emotional resonance of the performance. The focus will be on simplicity and organic sound, enhancing the storytelling without overwhelming the performance.

Feasibility

This preview performance of The Seer's Prophecy is a one-hour taste of a larger work still in its early stages of creation. Designed to be both manageable and impactful, it offers a focused, condensed experience that highlights the core themes, music, and storytelling of the full show. The minimal set, simple costumes, and flexible musical structure allow the production to be scaled appropriately for this early stage, while still delivering an engaging and immersive experience. The use of looping, shadow puppetry, and atmospheric sound creates a rich and layered performance without the need for a large crew or extensive technical elements, making it a feasible and exciting first step in bringing this ambitious work to life. This preview serves as a powerful introduction to the larger vision, allowing for feedback and refinement as the show continues to develop.

Musical Excerpts



Oh bright one



Every Night I Die Again

Fire and Ice